

Instructor Troubleshooting Guide

Common student reactions — and exactly what to do.

1. "The Giggles"

The Issue: Students (especially children or teens) giggle when asked to close their eyes or breathe deeply.

The Fix: Do not scold them. Giggling is often a release of nervous energy or a defense mechanism against feeling vulnerable.

What to Say: *"It's okay to giggle; that's just energy leaving the body. Let it out, smile, and then bring your focus back to your breath."*

2. "The Skeptic"

The Issue: A student feels this is "boring" or "not real fighting."

The Fix: Pivot to the science. Avoid "spiritual" language and use "performance" language.

What to Say: *"This isn't just relaxing. We are thickening the prefrontal cortex so you don't freeze in a real fight. This is brain conditioning."*

3. "The Sleeper"

The Issue: A student falls asleep during a script.

The Fix: This usually means the student is exhausted or feels very safe in your dojo. Gently wake them at the end.

What to Say: *"You clearly needed that rest, but next time try to keep the mind awake while the body rests."*

4. "The Fidgeter"

The Issue: A student cannot sit still for 60 seconds.

The Fix: Allow them to stand in a horse stance or lie down. Some nervous systems process stillness better when muscles are engaged (horse stance) or fully supported (lying down).

What to Say: *"No specific script needed — simply offer the alternative position and proceed."*